B2B Market Infrastructure: an Outside Read

The company is preparing a capital raise while working to increase visibility and generate new business. This read covers what sits outside the company and could affect those objectives, through Signal Shift's three lenses: Trust, Traction, and Conditions. Interpretation, recommendations, and the Proceed / Adjust / Reconsider call are Signal Shift's. Public sources only, checked in October 2026. The company's name, the size of its raise, and other identifying details have been removed, and figures that could identify the company are rounded.

Bottom line: on paper, the company holds a strong position: an established business with its own regulated arm that keeps the investor records for the securities its clients issue. In public, that strength is hard to see: few third parties confirm its news, the individual investor accounts on its records are falling, and demand is moving away from the segment where nearly half of its identifiable clients raise. Around it, the best-known tokenization firms are turning to listed companies, new demand is going to advertised private placements, funds, and broker platforms, and in its segment what investors can check is third-party confirmation, not press coverage.

The Independent Judgment: ADJUST

The findings do not establish that the direction is wrong: the regulator and the industry's largest players are confirming the role its record-keeping arm already holds. They identify three considerations to address before the raise: independent recognition (Trust), the gap between client securities on record and investor accounts (Traction), and a market moving toward buyers that need a register (Conditions).

WHAT SUPPORTS THE DIRECTION

The regulator has proposed new rules for the record-keeping the company already does, written for electronic and blockchain-based records, and the industry's largest players are confirming that role. Dozens of issuers name its record-keeping arm in their own filings.

WHAT'S WORTH CONSIDERING

New crowdfunding offerings fell 30% in a year, while advertised private placements and new venture fund filings grew (October to March, latest SEC data). The best-known tokenization firms are turning to listed companies.

WHAT DESERVES A CLOSER LOOK

About 40 announcements, one independent article. A minority of the partners it announced, about one in five, confirmed the partnership in their own name. Individual investor accounts down about 20% while the client securities on its records rose more than 15%.

Pages 2 to 7: for each lens, the questions for leadership, what the public record shows, the finding, and the actions leadership can assign.

1 Trust DESERVES A CLOSER LOOK

Is the company's story holding up from the outside?

Meaningful differences in visibility versus relevant competitors, including independent coverage, messaging, and changes over time. Measurable changes in independent coverage, customer announcements, partnerships, and external recognition; publicity distinguished from verified business activity.

THE QUESTIONS FOR LEADERSHIP

1. *Why do about 40 releases about the company produce one independent article, and does the public get the information it needs to judge the company?*
2. *Why has only a minority of the partners announced since February, about one in five, confirmed the partnership in their own name?*

WHAT THE PUBLIC RECORD SHOWS

- **Visibility: the gap is pickup, not volume.** The company published about 40 releases about itself in eight months, also reposted on other sites' press-release pages; one was written up by an outlet on a 20-outlet panel of news sites, mostly crypto and fintech. Competitor A published 5 and drew 4 articles. A crypto news site outside the panel noted that the announcement it covered named no live deployment, customer, transaction value, regulatory approval or launch date.
- **Publicity against verified activity.** A minority of the partners the company announced since February, about one in five, have confirmed in their own name or co-signed, mostly media and community partners; the most recent ones have not yet. Competitor A's main partner confirmed the partnership in its own name.
- **External recognition.** None of the three 2026 online lists of top tokenization platforms includes the company; the one 2026 ranking that names it does not place it among the leaders.

MEDIA: WHAT EACH PUBLISHED, AND WHAT OTHERS WROTE, LAST TWELVE MONTHS

COMPANY	OWN RELEASES	ARTICLES BY OTHERS ON 20 NEWS SITES (12 MONTHS BEFORE)	OF WHICH HEADLINES (BEFORE)	WHAT DREW COVERAGE
The company	About 40 (its own releases, also reposted on press-release pages)	1 (0)	1 (0)	A partnership announcement (October)
Competitor A	5	4 (1)	2 (0)	Company news
Competitor B	Not dated on its site	Several hundred (more than a hundred)	More than a hundred (dozens)	Corporate and product news
Competitor C	Dozens	About 50 (about 10)	About 20 (a few)	Partnership and legal news
Competitor D	0	2 (2)	1 (1)	Company news

Articles by others: 20 news sites, mostly crypto and fintech; crowdfunding trade titles are not part of the panel. Competitors A to D: the four peers compared, unnamed.

FINDING

Outside the company, few third parties confirm its news, and that is what investors check.

WHAT WE FOUND	About 40 releases since February, one independent headline on the panel; a minority of announced partners confirmed; the one ranking that names the company does not place it among the leaders; a corrected registration filing promised to the regulator and not yet filed.
WHAT CHANGED, WHEN	February to October 2026: frequent releases; first independent headline on the panel in October.
SOURCES	Signal Shift counts on 20 news sites; the company's own releases; partners' own sites; regulatory filing lists.
WHY IT MATTERS	**Raise:** diligence checks claims against third parties. **Visibility:** output is high, pickup close to zero. **New business:** prospects cannot verify most announced partners.
COMMERCIAL APPLICATION	**Concern:** investors check claims against third parties, and few confirm the company's news today. **Opportunity:** a few partners already confirm in their own name, and the most recent ones can be asked to.
ACTIONS LEADERSHIP CAN ASSIGN	1. Ask the most recently announced partners to confirm the partnership on their own site or in a joint release. Done when each confirmation is public. 2. In the next announcements, give what that coverage found missing: a named customer, a transaction value, or a launch date. 3. Put the record in order before investors look: file the corrected registration filing promised to the regulator.

2 Traction DESERVES A CLOSER LOOK

Is the expected momentum developing?

THE QUESTIONS FOR LEADERSHIP

1. *Why did individual investor accounts fall about 20% in 2025 while the client securities on record rose more than 15%?*
2. *Why does Competitor A gain accounts (up about a third) with the same type of issuers?*

WHAT THE PUBLIC RECORD SHOWS

- **Securities up, accounts down.** In the annual regulatory filing of its record-keeping arm, the client securities on its records rose more than 15% in 2025 while its individual investor accounts fell about 20%, with no reason given.
- **The rivals that grow in the company's segment are Competitors A and D.** Competitor A more than doubled the securities on its records and grew its accounts by about a third; Competitor D grew its securities by about 70%. Competitors B and C are turning to listed companies.

RECORD-KEEPING ARMS' ANNUAL REGULATORY FILINGS, 2025 AGAINST 2024

RECORD-KEEPING ARM	CLIENT SECURITIES ON ITS RECORDS	INDIVIDUAL INVESTOR ACCOUNTS
The company	More than +15%	**About −20%**
Competitor A	More than doubled	Up about a third
Competitor D	About +70%	Up less than 10%
Competitor B	Up	Flat
Competitor C	Inactive	Inactive

Every record-keeping arm of this kind files an annual report with the regulator each March. Securities are those it keeps registers for; accounts are the individual holders on those registers. Changes rounded.

THE COMPETITION, AND WHERE EACH STANDS AGAINST THE COMPANY

COMPANY	WHAT IT IS	VERIFIED SCALE, 2025 AGAINST 2024	ADVANTAGE	WEAKNESS
The company	Issuance software, its own regulated record-keeping arm, tokenization	Client securities on record up more than 15%; individual accounts down about 20%	Dozens of issuers name its record-keeping arm in their filings	Accounts down with no reason given; a minority of announced partners confirmed; one independent headline in two years on the 20-outlet panel
Competitor A	Online raise platform with its own record-keeping arm, serving the same type of issuers	Securities more than doubled; accounts up about a third	Growing fast with the same issuers; its main partner confirmed in its own name	Almost no press
Competitor B	Tokenization firm centred on listed issuers and funds	Securities up; accounts flat	Capital and large alliances	Little focus on small private issuers
Competitor C	Tokenization firm with its own record-keeping arm	Record-keeping arm inactive	A name investors know; regular press coverage	Its message has moved toward listed markets
Competitor D	Digital record-keeping and tokenization for private issuers	Securities up about 70%; accounts up less than 10%	More securities on record than the company, still growing	Almost no press

FINDING

The rivals that grow in the company's segment are Competitors A and D, and their annual filings are public.

WHAT WE FOUND	Competitor A more than doubled the securities on its records and grew its accounts by about a third in 2025; Competitor D grew its securities by about 70%; the company had more than 15% more client securities on its records but about 20% fewer accounts, with no reason given. Competitors B and C are turning to listed companies.
WHAT CHANGED, WHEN	2024 to 2025 in the annual regulatory filings; October 2025 to October 2026 for the moves of Competitors B and C.
SOURCES	Annual regulatory filings and other public filings; companies' releases and sites.
WHY IT MATTERS	**Raise:** any investor's analyst can pull these filings and will ask about the fall in accounts. **New business:** the closest rival grows with the same issuers.
COMMERCIAL APPLICATION	**Concern:** the account figures need an explanation before investors ask. **Opportunity:** the best-known tokenization firms do not put small private issuers forward.
ACTIONS LEADERSHIP CAN ASSIGN	1. Write a short explanation of the fall in accounts and add it to the investor materials before anyone asks. 2. Lead with the growth that is verifiable: client securities on record up more than 15%, and the dozens of issuers that name its record-keeping arm in their own filings. 3. Review the issuers won and lost over the last twelve months against Competitor A: which offering types and sizes went to Competitor A, and why.

3 Conditions WORTH CONSIDERING, AND AN OPENING

Has something around the company changed that could influence the outcome?

Specific competitor developments, changes in customer demand, market activity, or potential partnerships that could affect the company.

THE QUESTIONS FOR LEADERSHIP

1. *Demand is moving to funds, SPVs, and broker platforms: who chooses the record-keeper in these channels, and is the company part of those conversations?*

WHAT THE PUBLIC RECORD SHOWS

- **Customer demand is moving.** New crowdfunding offerings (Reg CF, up to $5M) fell 30% in a year, from 1,173 to 820, while Reg A stayed flat at 154. Advertised private placements by operating companies (Reg D 506(c)) rose 13%, and new venture capital fund notices 33%, October to March, year on year. For the company: nearly half of the issuers that name its record-keeping arm in their filings raise under Reg CF, the shrinking part.
- **The best-known tokenization firms are turning to listed companies.** Competitor B presents its new record-keeping partnerships as supporting tokenized shares of public companies, and its registration statement does not mention Reg A or Reg CF. Competitor C now puts listed markets forward. For the company: neither puts small private issuers forward; Competitor A does.
- **The big money goes to listed markets first.** A crypto exchange agreed to acquire a leading firm in the company's line of business; the tokenization programs of the US settlement system and of a major exchange cover large listed stocks and major ETFs. For the company: money and infrastructure go to listed companies first.
- **The regulator is writing the role into its rules.** On 1 September the SEC proposed new rules for this kind of record-keeping, written to reflect electronic and blockchain-based records; comments close on 3 November. For the company: a dated window.
- **New buyers need registers.** A major US broker bought a private-share marketplace (March); a trading app launched single-company SPVs with no record-keeper named in the launch release (June); leading private AI companies now police who may hold their shares. For the company: SPV sponsors, broker platforms, and fund managers are potential partners that may not be on the radar.

PRIVATE OFFERINGS FILED WITH THE SEC	12 MONTHS BEFORE	LAST 12 MONTHS	CHANGE
Reg CF (crowdfunding, up to $5M): new offerings	1,173	820	**−30%**
Reg A (up to $75M): new offering statements	154	154	0%
Reg D 506(c): advertised private placements by companies*	1,222	1,384	**+13%**
Reg D: new venture capital fund notices*	3,341	4,454	**+33%**

Reg CF and Reg A: 14 Oct 2024 to 13 Oct 2025 against 14 Oct 2025 to 9 Oct 2026. *Reg D: new notices, October to March a year apart; the SEC data sets stop at March 2026.

FINDING

Demand is moving from crowdfunding to funds, SPVs, and broker platforms that each need a register.

WHAT WE FOUND	Reg CF new offerings −30% in a year; venture capital fund notices +33% and advertised private placements +13% (October to March); a major broker bought a private-share marketplace; a trading app launched single-company SPVs with no record-keeper named; nearly half of the issuers naming its record-keeping arm raise under Reg CF.
WHAT CHANGED, WHEN	Over the last twelve months for Reg CF and Reg A; October to March, a year apart, for Reg D; March to June 2026 for the broker, trading-app and AI-company moves.
SOURCES	SEC form index and Form D data sets; regulatory filing search; the companies' own pages.
WHY IT MATTERS	**New business:** the growth is with buyers that need a register, not with crowdfunding issuers. **Raise:** nearly half of the identifiable issuers raise in the segment that shrank.
COMMERCIAL APPLICATION	**Opportunity:** SPV sponsors, broker platforms, and venture fund managers as register customers. **Concern:** the crowdfunding share of the identifiable customers.
ACTIONS LEADERSHIP CAN ASSIGN	1. File a comment letter on the regulator's proposed rules before 3 November. 2. Approach SPV sponsors, broker platforms, and venture fund managers as register customers. 3. Point business development toward advertised private placements (Reg D 506(c), up 13%) to reduce the weight of crowdfunding.

WHAT THE OUTSIDE RECORD SHOWS IN THE COMPANY'S FAVOUR

- The regulator is writing this kind of record-keeping into tokenized securities, and a crypto exchange agreed to acquire a leading firm in the same line of business: the role the company already holds is the one large buyers pay for.
- Dozens of issuers name its record-keeping arm in their own filings.

Every figure comes from a public document. Sources are held by Signal Shift and withheld to protect the company. Names and identifying details removed; figures that could identify a company rounded.

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